NOTING that, at several places, the entrances to the Baltic Sea are difficult to navigat e, RESOLUTION MSC.138(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THRO UGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEAMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 12 Page 2 - RESOLUTION MSC.138(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO T HE BALTIC SEAMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 12 Page 2 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC NOTING ALSO that, ow ing to the risk of grounding or collision and the strong sea current, the navigation of large ships through the entrances to the Baltic Sea constitutes a potential danger of po llution of the entrances and of the entire Baltic Sea area, NOTING FURTHER that loaded o il and chemical tankers, gas carriers and ships carrying a cargo of irradiated nuclear f uel, plutonium and high-level radioactive wastes (INF-cargoes) constitute a potential da nger of pollution of the entrances to the Baltic Sea and a potential hazard to internati onal shipping, HAVING CONSIDERED the recommendations of the Sub-Committee on Safety of N avigation at its forty-eighth session, 1.

ADOPTS, in accordance with SOLAS regulation V/10, the Recommendation on navigation throu gh the entrances to the Baltic Sea, as given in Annexes 1 and 2 to the present resolutio n; 2.

DECIDES that the said Annexes w ill enter into force at 0000 hours UTC on 1 December 200 3; - navigation through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, as given in Annexes 1 and 2 to the present resolution; 2.

DECIDES that the said Annexes w ill enter into force at 0000 hours UTC on 1 December 200 3; 3.

REQUESTS the Secretary-General to bring this resolution and its Annexes to the attention of Member Governments and C ontracting Governments to the 1974 SOLAS Convention.

RESOLUTION MSC.138(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEAMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 12 Page 3 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC AN NEX 1 RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEA ROUTE - T 1 S hips over 40,000 tonnes deadweight, when pa ssing through the entrances to the Baltic Se a, in view of the f act that 17 m is the maximum obtainable depth without dredging in th e are